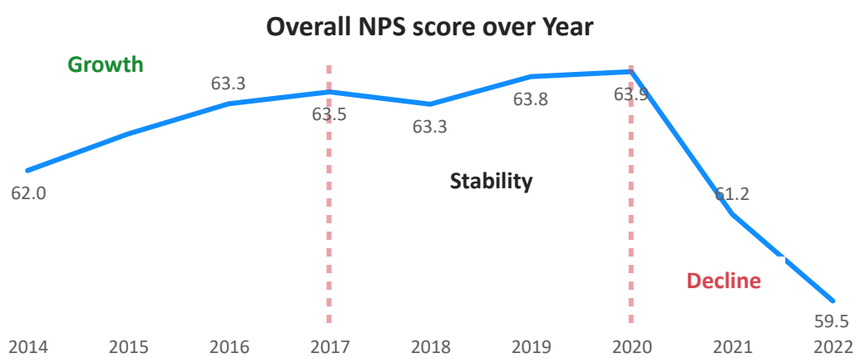
DID COVID-19 TRIGGER LOSS OF TRUST IN AMERICA'S HOSPITALS?

Select Reporting Year

Friday, September 30, 2022

1. The Pandemic Has Brought a Shift in Patient Satisfaction Indicators

NPS was on an **upward trend** between 2013 and 2016. It then entered a **stable period** until 2020, indicating growing trust and satisfaction among patients. However, **COVID-19** reversed this trend.



Communication about Medicines (1), Care Transition (2), Quietness of Hospital Environment and (4) Responsiveness of Hospital staff are the four main areas where hospitals were consistently less effective

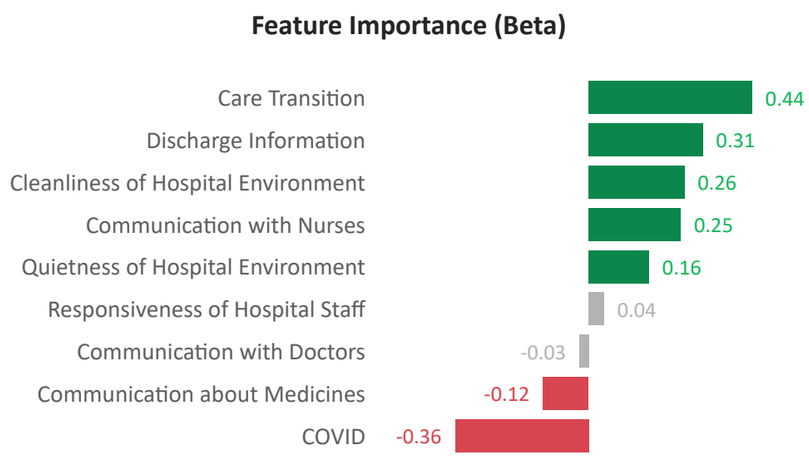
NPS Score and Performance by Measure

Measure	NPS change vs Last 2 Years	NPS This Year
Communication with Doctors	-3.08	74.4
Communication with Nurses	-3.04	74.1
Discharge Information	-2.82	71.3
Cleanliness of Hospital Environment	-6.20	61.9
Overall Hospital Rating	-4.33	61.0
Responsiveness of Hospital Staff	-7.24	55.1
Quietness of Hospital Environment	-1.16	51.0
Care Transition	-4.00	45.0
Communication about Medicines	-7.90	41.5

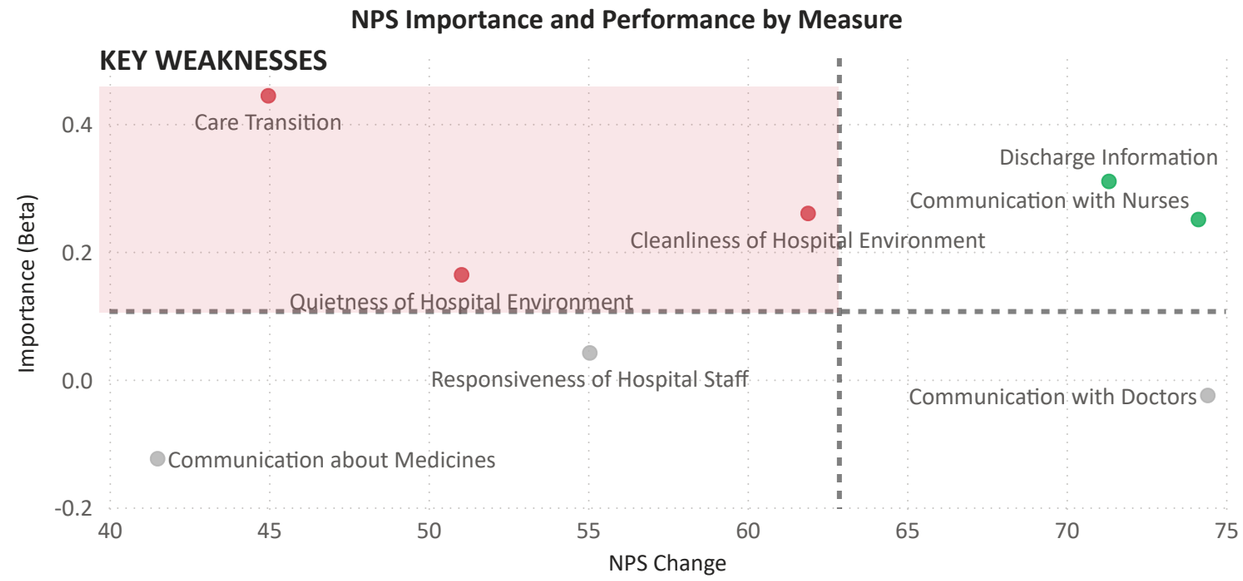
Areas underperforms vs national average are highlighted in red

2. Key Drivers Shaping Patient Trust

Using multiple regression and including an indicator that accounts for the effects of COVID-19, these four factors account for 93% of the variation in NPS.
Regression Analysis: R2 = 0.93, n = 458 (all states and time period included)



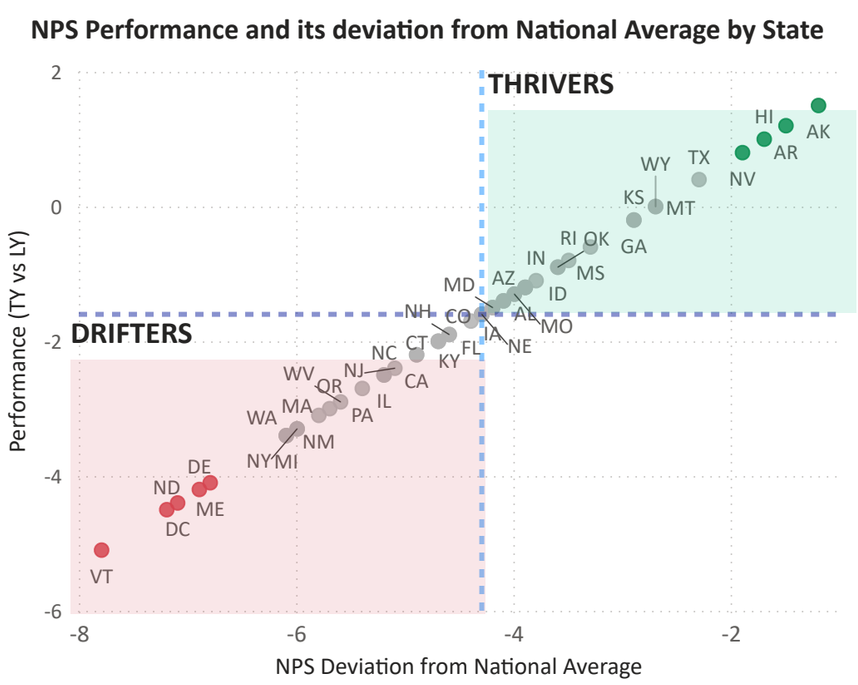
Overlaid with the current status, **Care Transition (1) , Cleanliness of Hospital (2)** should be fixed urgently. **Quietness of Hospital (3)** although having consistent dissatisfaction level, did not record significant decline during COVID.
In contrast, **Communication with Nurses and Discharge Information** are our recording strength (with high satisfaction level)



3. Key States to watch- Identifying Drifters and Thrivers

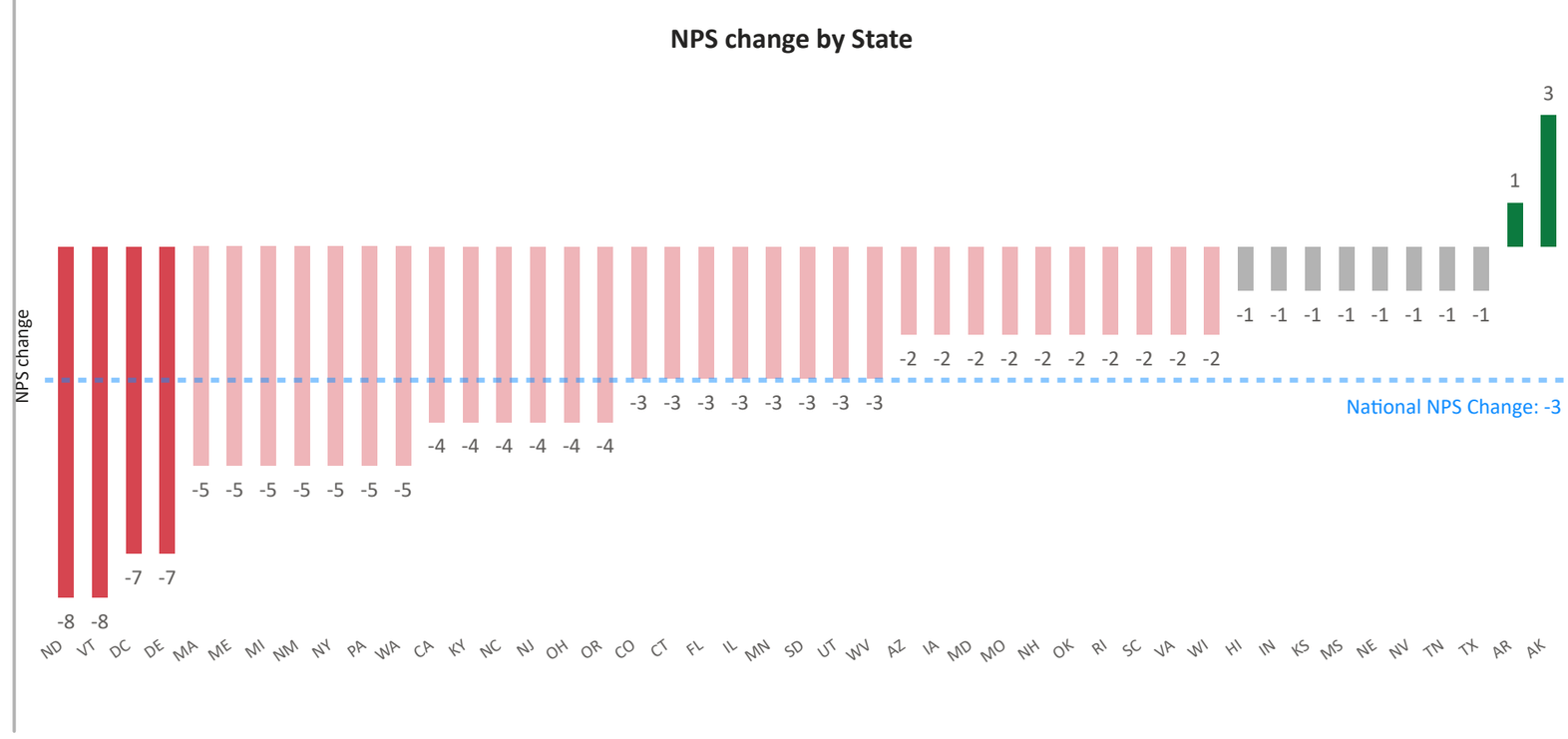
While **most states experienced changes** in NPS during COVID-19, a few stand out for their **larger deviation**

- 24 states have **a higher than national average drop in NPS** during COVID-19
- 19 states have a **lower than national average drop in NPS** during COVID-19
- 2 states witnessed **a boost in NPS** during COVID-19



Nevada, Virginia, DC are showing weakness in terms of their national average NPS change and difference in their during-COVID vs. pre-COVID scores.

In contrast, **Arlington and Ankasas** have showcased resilience, deviating positively from the pack.



4. Recommendations to gain patient trust

No.	Key Challenges	Issues	Solutions
1	Widespread decline in trust	COVID-19 brings about an unprecedented changes in hospitals, including altered care procedures and change in hospital environment. This shift might not always have aligned with patient satisfaction, leading to a drop in NPI	Prioritize transparent communication about changes in care procedures and safety protocols. Investigate best practices in Arlington and Arkansas to understand areas they did well so we can replicate in our states.
2	Care Transition & Discharge Info: Critical in shaping patient trust but underperforms	Despite its strong link with NPI, it consistently scores lower than other measures	Implements post-discharge communication protocols. This will help clear patient confusion upon discharge.
3	Cleanliness of Hospital Environment: Important but neglected during COVID time	Due to staff shortage, hospital environment was not in the best condition.	Establish a proper hospital cleaning protocols to ensure staff do not miss any key areas or points of contact during regular cleaning rounds.
4	Inconsistent feedback collection timing	Since feedback collection window is big (1-10 days), patient's recollection may vary. More quality feedback could be provided when patients' experience is fresh	Narrow down feedback collection window to 1-3 working days

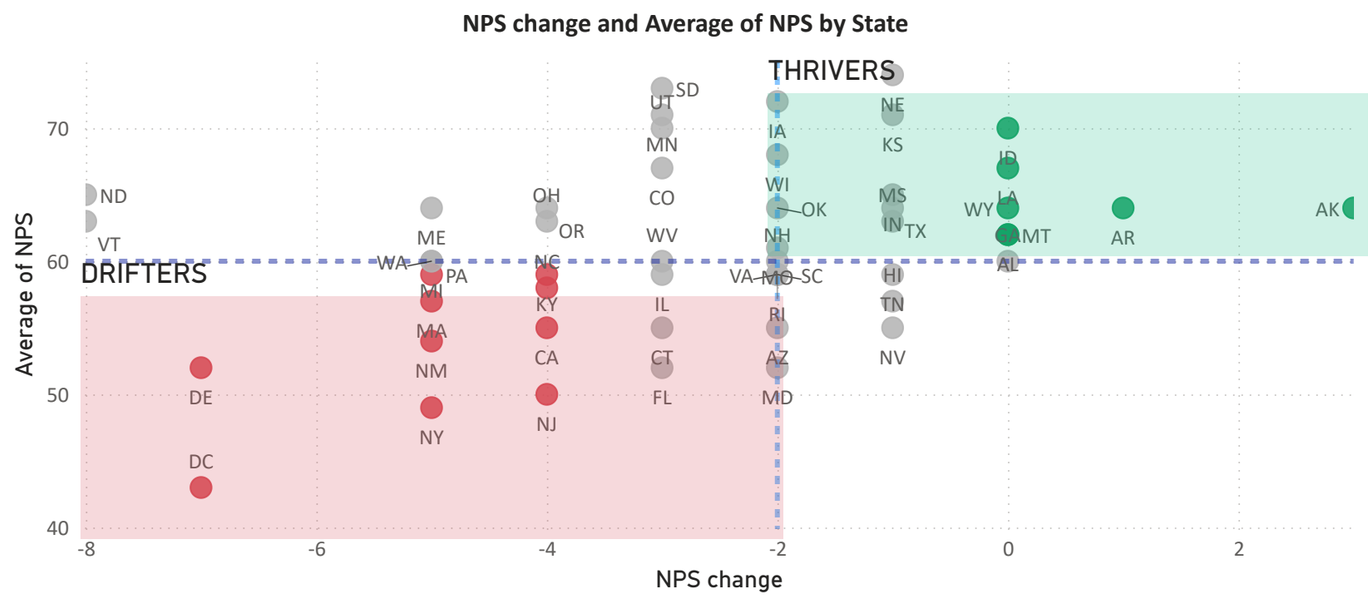
STATE ANALYSIS: TEXAS HOSPITALS' JOURNEY TO REGAIN PATIENT TRUST

Friday, September 30, 2022

1. Texas's relatively fair position in gaining patient satisfaction

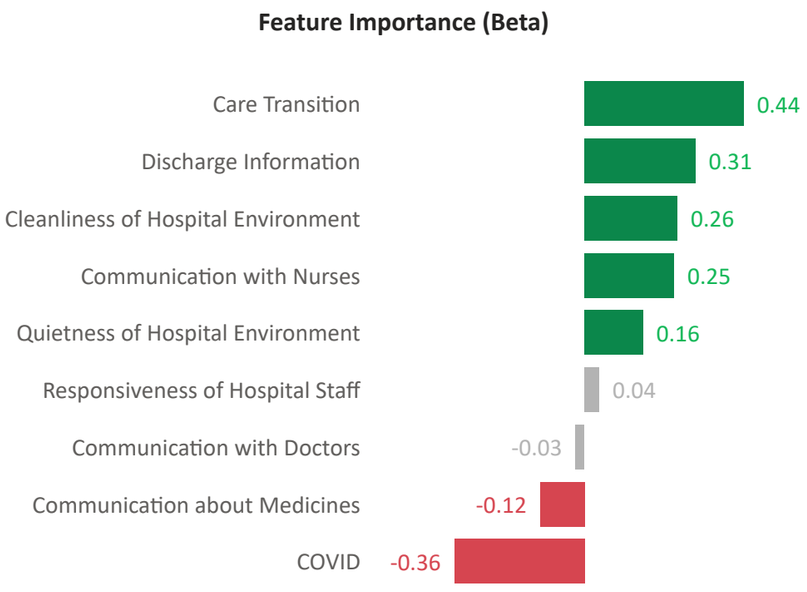
In 2023, Texas hospitals are among the decent performing state when it comes to patient satisfaction post COVID-19. While other states declined by -4.3 ppt, Texas recorded a smaller drop of -1.0 ppt. However, they have room for improvement in certain areas so they can be in better position next year.

This analysis will provide a detailed picture of what Texas hospitals were doing right to achieve the current patient satisfaction score. We will also showcase areas of improvement that help Texas propel their growth momentum.

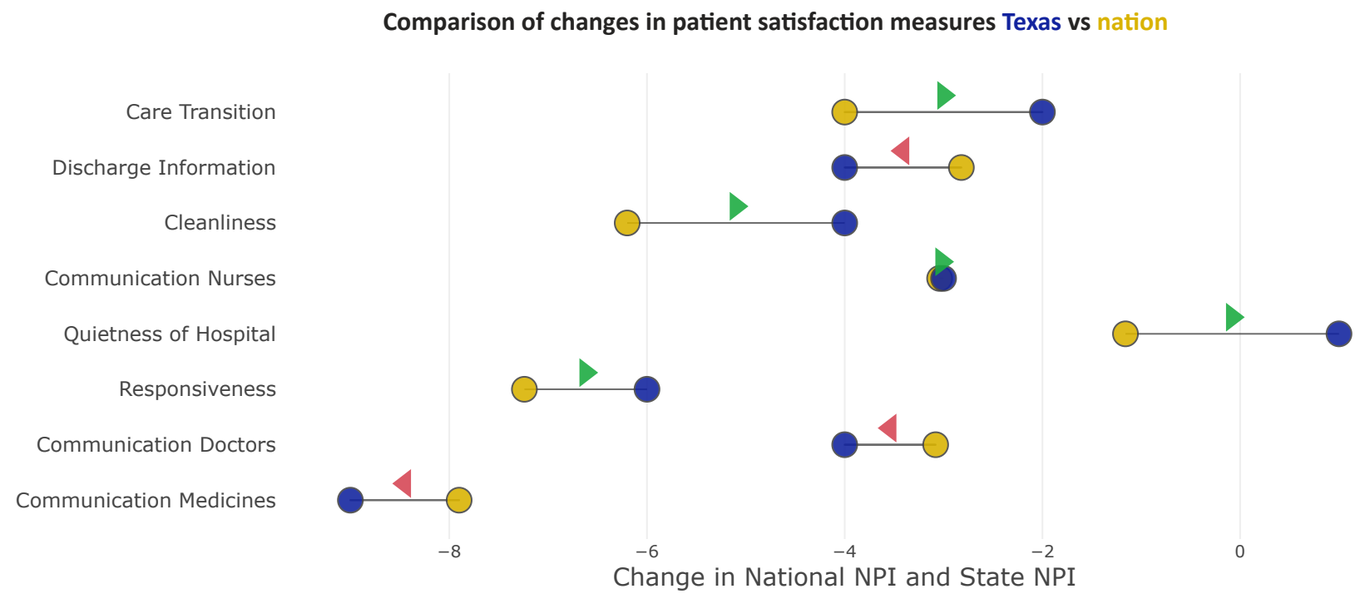


2. Key drivers to Texas hospitals to get to where they are now

Patient satisfaction is mainly driven by **Care Transition, Discharge Information and Cleanliness of Hospital Environment.**

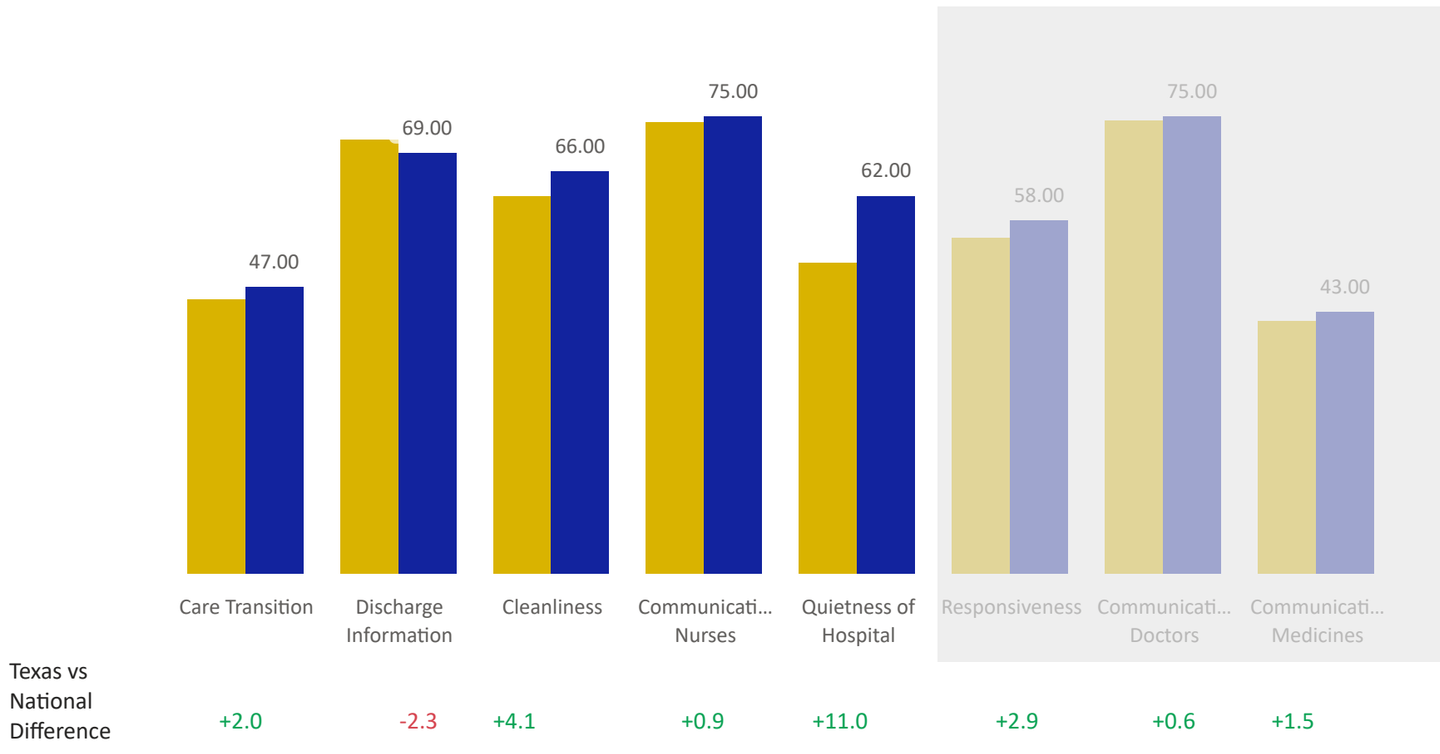


Texas hospitals have made progress particularly in areas that drive patient satisfaction, while the nation has been falling behind improving those same areas. Those areas are (1) Care Transition, (2) Discharge Information, (3) Hospital Cleanliness



3. Despite showing resilience during COVID-19, Texas hospitals have a lot of room for improvement to strengthen their position

Not all areas with lower satisfaction scores are concerning since many of them do not have a strong impact on overall patient satisfaction. It is not about fixing everything, but about strategically enhancing what matters most to patients.
Discharge information, despite it being critical in shaping patient satisfaction, is lacking compared to national average



4. Texas hospitals' Action Plan for Winning at patient satisfaction

1. Continue building on the positive momentum while addressing important areas. By doing so, they can align more closely with patient satisfaction and increase overall satisfaction.
2. Understand what drives patient satisfaction
3. Although Texas hospitals deliver well in important areas such as (1) Care Transition, (2) Discharge Information and (3) Hospital Cleanliness, they can thrive by working on Discharge Information as well.
4. Establish plans to concentrate resources and efforts on enhancing (1) Care Transition, (2) Discharge Information, (3) Cleanliness since they are most important in boosting NPI score and Texas hospitals have most potential to fix.